



NATIONAL ROCKETRY CHAMPIONSHIP 2025-26

Rule Book



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Document Information

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Table of Contents

1. Overview	4
2. Registration	4
2.1. Help From Outside Of Your Team	5
3. Key Dates	6
3.1 Important Deadlines and Dates	6
4. Scoring Criteria	7
4.1. Scoring Breakdown Table	7
4.2. Preliminary Design Review	8
4.3. Critical Design Review	8
4.4. Manufacturing Review	9
4.5. Altitude Marks	9
5. Deliverables	10
5.1. Submissions	10
5.2. Templates	10
5.3. Deliverable Formats	11
6. Rules	11





1. Overview

Once a team has designed a launch vehicle, they will have the opportunity to launch it along with all of the other teams at the NRC Competition Day. Pictures of the previous Competition Days can be found [here](#).

2. Registration

Teams must contain a **minimum of 4 members and a maximum of 10 members**. All team members must be eligible for UKSEDS membership. More information about membership eligibility and registration (it's free!) can be found [here](#).

Support: Finding Team Members

If you are an individual student looking to participate in NRC, but do not have access to a suitable institution to form or join a team, please email us at rocketry@ukseds.org and we will try our best to get you in touch with a local team.

UKSEDS have an extensive network of contacts at branches and in university departments across the country. We may be able to help you find team members if this is proving difficult. Please get in touch with the team contact if you need some support in organising your team.

Teams wishing to enter the competition must register. Throughout the competition, please direct any enquiries to rocketry@ukseds.org.

2.1 Large Societies Comps Liaison

Teams representing a society with more than two teams entering the competition must contact rocketry@ukseds.org before filling out the registration form. Teams must also nominate a "Competition Liaison" who shall act as a non-technical point of contact between the NRC Team and the society when required. The Competition Liaison can only be a member of one team. If the Competition Liaison is not a part of a team, they are not allowed to contribute technically to any of the society's teams. Reports originating from the same society will be scrutinised for plagiarism. If any evidence of blatant plagiarism is found, UKSEDS reserves the right to investigate further and apply penalties.

2.2 Motor Fees and Procurement

Note: due to substantial issues with motor supply in the UK over the last few years, **all motors for the competition shall be ordered by UKSEDS on behalf of the teams.**





Furthermore, owing to the supply issues, UKSEDS cannot guarantee the availability of all Flame types, motors types or grains.

A non-refundable motor fee of £30 will be charged to all teams before the preliminary design review (PDR). The exact deadline will be no later than 1 week before the PDR and will be shared with the teams well in advance. This will cover the cost of one motor per team. The motor will be made available to teams at the NRC Launch Day 2026. If a team decides to forfeit the competition, the motor will remain available for the team to use for the subsequent NRC Launch Day, their society/organisation (if either return the following year) or retained by UKSEDS as a bursary to teams requiring financial aid.

Rocket motors are more prone to failure the longer they sit on the shelf and are typically made to order. Thus, after the aforementioned one year has elapsed, the motor automatically lapses to UKSEDS ownership as a bursary for other teams. If a team misses Launch Day, UKSEDS and UKSEDS partners cannot guarantee the availability of the motors after this day.

2.1. Help From Outside Of Your Team

To ensure fair competition for all teams, the following table gives guidance on what is and is not allowed in terms of outside help.

Allowed	Not Allowed
Creation of hardware by third parties to student's design specification.	Creation of software by third parties to student's design specification.
Mentorship from outside of your team, e.g. academic supervisor or committee member, nudging your team in the right direction.	Mentorship from outside of your team, e.g. academic supervisor or committee member, telling your team what to do or managing the project.
Industry sponsorship.	Commercial off-the-shelf rocket kit.

3. Key Dates



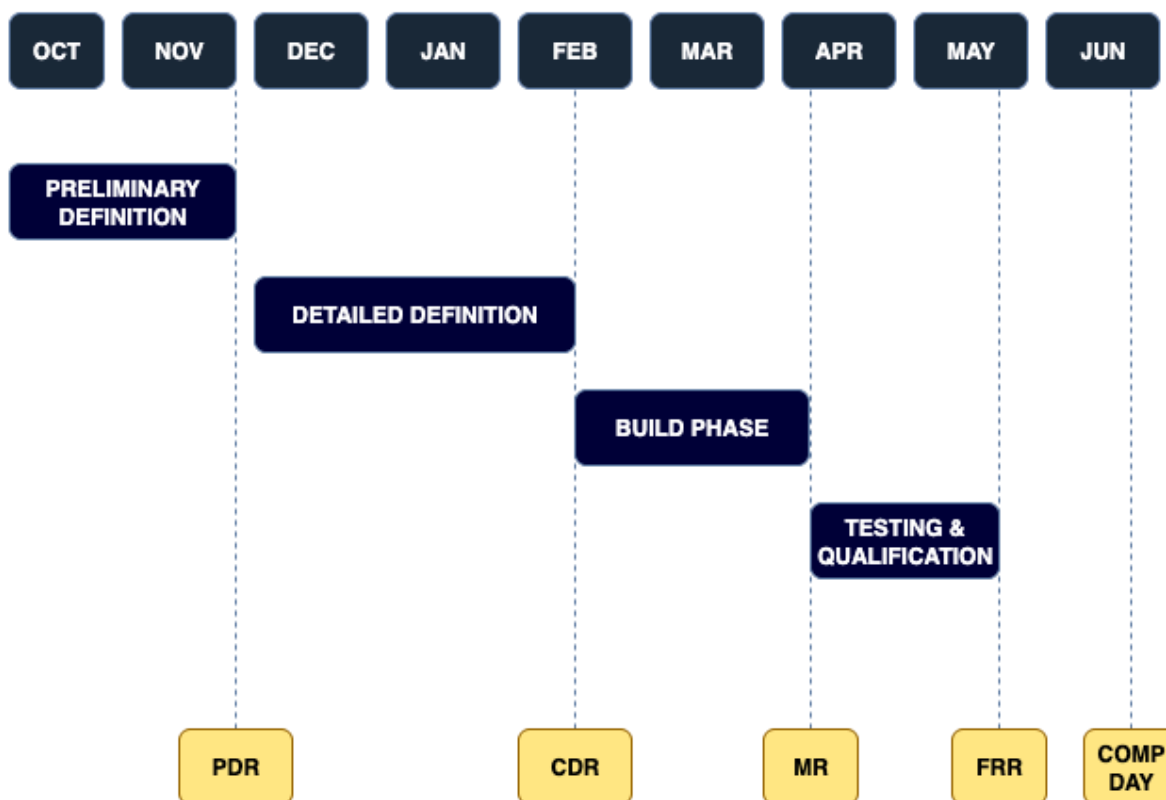


Figure 1: Key dates

3.1 Important Deadlines and Dates

Table 1: Deliverables with their respective due dates

Deliverable	Due Date
Motor Confirmation and Motor Fee	TBC
PDR (Marked)	12th December
CDR (Marked)	19th February
MR (Marked)	10th April
FRR (Pass/Fail)	2nd June
LAUNCH DAY (Marked)	Primary Day: 17th June Backup Day: 24th June





4. Scoring Criteria

Teams will be scored in two main areas:

- Deliverables
- Launch Day

There is an even split in the marks between the two areas, so each team's overall mark depends on their work throughout the year just as much as their performance on Launch Day. The winning team is likely to excel in both areas.

4.1. Scoring Breakdown Table

Criteria	Points
Deliverables	500
Preliminary Design Review	200
Critical Design Review	200
Manufacturing Review	100
Launch Day	500
Team's preparedness	25
"The Customer's" payload integration	25
Target altitude	200
Recovery system deployment	50
Successful recovery with minimal damage*	50
Rideshare payload data	100
Rideshare payload innovation	50
Total	1000

* Minimal damage shall be defined as the launch vehicle retaining its ability to be flown again on the same day with minor repairs and effectively remaining 'motor ready'.





4.2.Preliminary Design Review

Criteria	Percentage
Quality of launch vehicle design	20
Communication of design	20
Simulation data	20
Quality of rideshare payload design	10
Systems engineering	10
Project management	10
Testing	5
Media	5
Total	100

4.3. Critical Design Review

Criteria	Percentage
Quality of launch vehicle design	15
Communication of design	15
Simulation data	15
Quality of rideshare payload design	10
Systems engineering	10
Project management	10
Manufacturing techniques	10
Testing	10
Media	5





Total	100
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4.4. Manufacturing Review

Criteria	Percentage
Quality of launch vehicle manufacture	20
Communication of manufacture	15
Testing	15
Media	15
Quality of rideshare payload manufacture	10
Systems engineering	10
Project management	10
Simulation data	5
Total	100

4.5. Altitude Marks

A graph showing the distribution of marks against apogee altitude can be found below. Please note that heavy penalisation shall occur above 3000 ft, as this altitude is the dual-deployment limit. The Notice To Airmen (NOTAM) limit for Midlands Rocketry Club is 3500ft, so a mark of 0 shall be given to any teams that breach this limit.



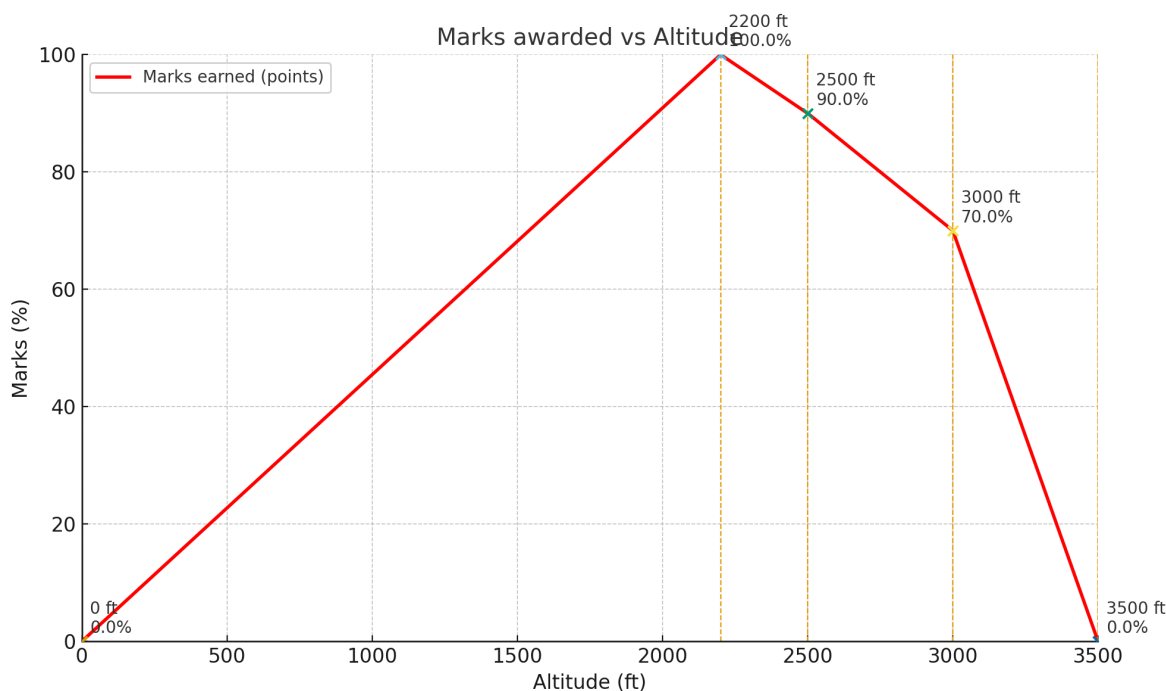


Figure 2: Distribution of marks against altitude.

5. Deliverables

5.1. Submissions

All deliverables should be submitted through the submission portal available to teams via email. Teams should follow instructions on the specific deliverables' upload points and will be reminded by email when the submission dates are close.

5.2. Templates

All deliverables are accompanied by templates that must be used and can be found [here](#). Additional content may be added to these templates, but the original topics covered by the templates must be included. In order to avoid penalties, teams must obey the time or page limits stated in the templates.





5.3. Deliverable Formats

The deliverable formats are as follows:

- Preliminary Design Review
 - 10-minute recorded presentation
- Critical Design Review
 - Written document, maximum of 30 pages
- Manufacturing Report
 - 10-minute recorded presentation
- Flight Readiness Review
 - Unrecorded presentation, no slide limit

6. Rules

The UKSEDS National Rocketry Championship is organised in the spirit of healthy competition. Rules have been published below to maintain a high standard of safety and fairness for all participants.

1. This competition is open to all UK Students for the Exploration and Development of Space branches. Other teams wishing to participate are welcome but must gain consent by emailing rocketry@ukseds.org.
2. All participants must adhere to the UKSEDS Code of Conduct. The Code of Conduct is available on the NRC Statement of Work 25/26.
3. All rocketry activities must abide by the United Kingdom Rocketry Association (UKRA) Safety Code, which can be found [here](#).
4. Submissions should be the team's own work. Any plagiarism will not be tolerated.
5. All teams and launches must abide by local laws and CAA regulations for unmanned rocket launches. Safety must take the highest priority in launch preparations and flight operations. UKSEDS retains no responsibility for the launch rules and regulations that the competing teams shall be required to follow.
6. All teams must listen to and respect the UKSEDS volunteers and the Range-Safety Officer (RSO) on the competition day. Their say is final.
7. All launches must be performed entirely through the motor's own power. Speciality launch systems (i.e. Rockoon and projectile launching) are not permitted.
8. All rockets must be successfully recovered with minimal damage. Minimal





damage shall be defined as the launch vehicle retaining its ability to be flown again on the same day with minor repairs and effectively remaining 'motor ready'.. The team and the RSO must document successful recovery.

9. Team members must wait for explicit instructions from the RSO before leaving the launch pad to recover their rocket. This is to ensure health and safety as the launch site is an active airfield.

7. Awards

As a conclusion and a commendation of the team's efforts, a limited number of awards are presented to the teams with outstanding effort in certain aspects to acknowledge their dedication. Awards are given based on various criteria based on marked deliverables throughout the year.

Award	Criteria
Winner	Awarded to the team with the best performance overall in all deliverables.
Best Rideshare Payload	Awarded to the team with the best Rideshare Payload design.
Closest to 2200ft	Awarded to the launch vehicle which achieved the closest apogee to 2200ft, as measured by "The Customer's Payload".
Public Engagement Award	Awarded to the team with the best Public Engagement.
Honorable Mentions	Awarded to the teams scoring the second and third-highest totals in all deliverables.

Additionally, there may be awards presented by sponsors on the competition day.

